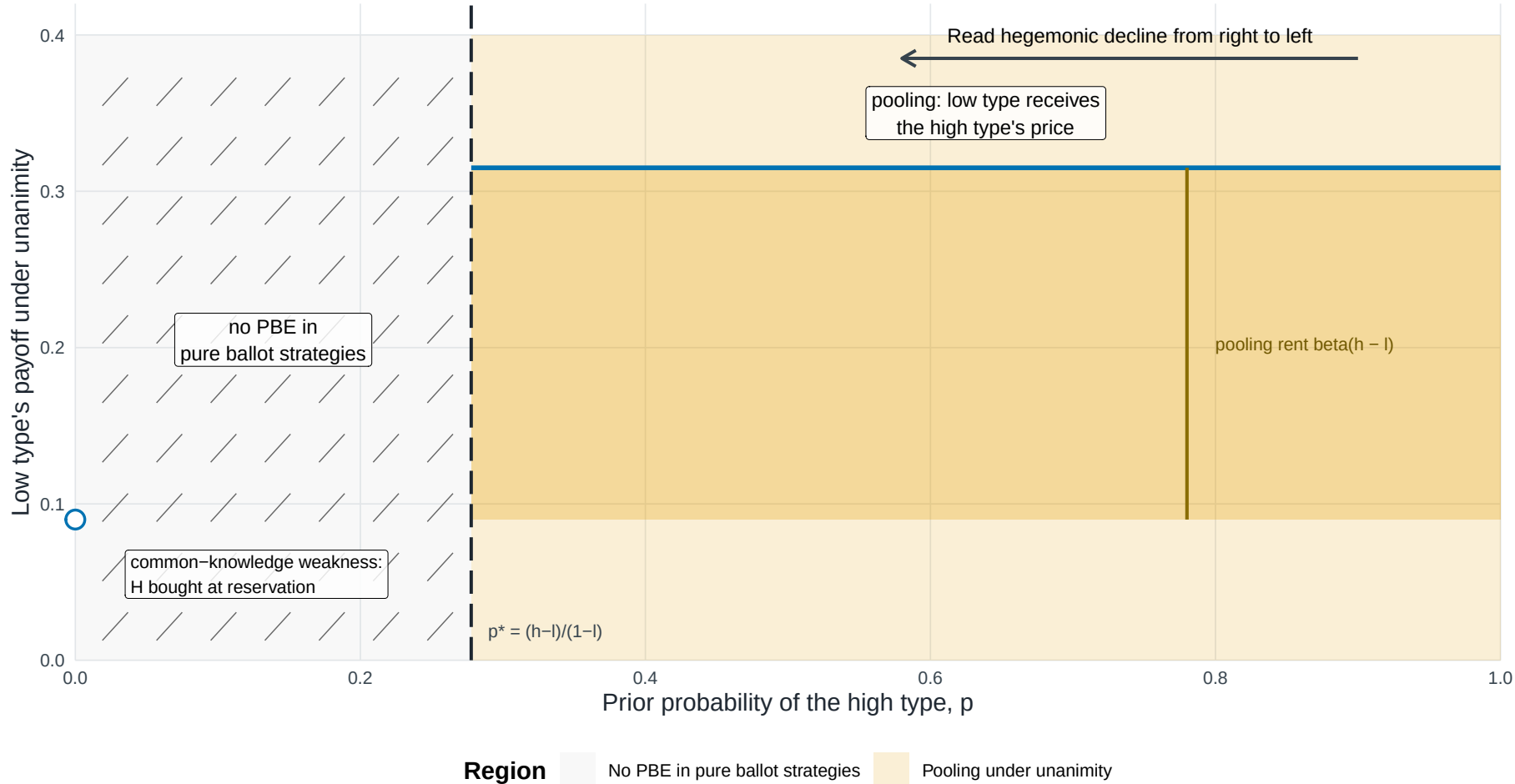


Hegemonic decline across pooling, nonexistence, and the endpoint

$l = 0.100$; $h = 0.350$; $m = 4$ weak states; $\beta = 0.90$



The figure should be read from high to low p . Above p^* , pooling pays the low type βh , creating the rent $\beta(h - l)$ relative to its reservation price βl . The light orange field identifies the pooling region; the darker band isolates the payoff-relevant rent between βl and βh . For $0 < p \leq p^*$, the hatched area records the absence of a perfect Bayesian equilibrium in pure ballot strategies; $p = 0$ is an isolated complete-information endpoint, not an interval, and the low type is bought at reservation. The figure makes no claim about equilibria involving mixed ballot strategies. Note: Model-generated regions; all boundaries closed-form.